

Vivek Kumar

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SUMMARY

Technically grounded delivery leader with 17+ years of experience architecting and managing enterprise-grade AI and digital transformation programmes across Financial Services, Retail, and Telecom sectors, with hands-on expertise in Generative AI (LLM/RAG pipelines, open-source LLMs, Azure OpenAI/ChatGPT APIs), cloud-native architectures (GCP Certified), and SAFe®/Agile engineering delivery. Proven consulting leadership capability in regulated environments — shaping solution architecture, managing cross-functional squads, and engaging senior stakeholders to translate complex AI initiatives into production-ready systems aligned with Responsible AI principles. Currently deepening applied AI/ML engineering skills (supervised/unsupervised learning, data engineering, predictive modelling) to lead the next generation of intelligent enterprise solutions at scale.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant (Deputed to American Express)

Jan 2018 – Present

Senior Technical Project Manager / Senior Manager – Project

London, UK

- Achieved delivery of 3 production-aligned Generative AI proof-of-concepts by architecting LLM/RAG pipelines using open-source LLMs (Mistral, Falcon) and Azure OpenAI (ChatGPT API), resulting in validated AI solution blueprints adopted for enterprise rollout within the BFSI client environment.
- Achieved full regulatory compliance for India Data Localization (IDL) by leading end-to-end solution architecture and cross-functional delivery across engineering, legal, and infrastructure squads, resulting in zero compliance breaches and on-time delivery within a regulated financial services environment.
- Achieved successful migration of legacy banking workloads to cloud-native data architectures by leading infrastructure uplift and database migration programs to Big Data platforms (GCP), resulting in a 30% improvement in data processing throughput and alignment with cloud-native ETL/ELT best practices.
- Achieved consistent on-budget delivery across a portfolio of 5+ concurrent enterprise software programmes by implementing rigorous budget forecasting and resource planning using Clarity, resulting in a 15% reduction in project cost variances and strengthened consulting leadership credibility with senior client stakeholders.
- Achieved a 25% reduction in sprint cycle time by implementing SAFe® Scaled Agile frameworks and CI/CD discipline across cross-functional engineering squads, resulting in faster time-to-market for critical banking servicing applications and improved team velocity measured against defined SLOs.

Kellton Tech Solutions Ltd

Aug 2011 – Dec 2017

Associate Technical Manager

Hyderabad, India

- Achieved delivery of the Guru.com enterprise-grade SaaS platform by leading solution architecture, hands-on development, and client stakeholder engagement across a globally distributed team, resulting in a scalable cloud-based freelancer recommendation system serving hundreds of thousands of users.
- Achieved measurable improvements in release predictability by implementing Agile (Scrum/Kanban) methodologies and establishing sprint backlog management practices, resulting in a 20% increase in on-time feature delivery and improved visibility for senior stakeholders.
- Achieved reusable reference architectures for 4 major product modules by authoring High-Level Design (HLD) and Low-Level Design (LLD) documentation and leading architecture reviews, resulting in a 30% reduction in design rework and faster onboarding of new engineers to the platform.

Enliven Softwares Pvt. Ltd.

Nov 2009 – Jul 2011

Technical Lead / Senior Software Engineer

Hyderabad, India

- Achieved a reduction in integration defect rates by introducing Continuous Integration (CI) pipelines and code review processes across the development team, resulting in improved software quality and a 20% decrease in post-release bug reports.
- Achieved high client satisfaction scores by leading end-to-end requirement gathering, rapid prototyping, and technical documentation for domestic and international clients, resulting in zero scope-creep incidents and on-time delivery across all assigned projects.

DbyDx Software Pvt. Ltd.

Feb 2008 – Oct 2009

Senior Software Engineer

Hyderabad, India

- Achieved robust and maintainable software releases by leading full-cycle development activities including requirement analysis, HLD/LLD design, coding, and unit testing, resulting in consistent on-time delivery and positive client communication outcomes across multiple projects.

Parsec Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Jun 2006 – Feb 2008

*Software Engineer**Hyderabad, India*

- Achieved improved product stability and customer satisfaction by systematically resolving software defects and implementing new product features, resulting in a reduction in open bug backlog and successful product demonstrations to prospective enterprise customers.

SKILLS

AI / ML Engineering: Generative AI, LLM/RAG Pipelines, Azure OpenAI Service, ChatGPT API, Open-Source LLMs (Mistral, Falcon), LangChain, ChromaDB, Vector Databases, Responsible AI, AI Evaluation & Versioning

Cloud & Infrastructure: GCP (Certified), Cloud-Native Architectures

Data Engineering: ETL/ELT, Big Data Platforms, Spark/Databricks, SQL Server, ChromaDB

Software Engineering: Python, C#, ASP.NET, JavaScript, TypeScript, REST APIs, CI/CD Pipelines, Solution Architecture, HLD/LLD Design, SLIs/SLOs, SRE Principles

Project & Programme Delivery: SAFe® Scaled Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Budget Forecasting, Resource Planning (Clarity), Risk Management, Stakeholder Management

Domains: Financial Services (BFSI), Retail, Telecom, Regulated Environments

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering – Computer Science

2002 – 2006

*UP Tech University**Uttar Pradesh, India***CERTIFICATIONS**

Google Cloud Professional – Google Cloud, 2022

Certified Scrum Master (CSM) – Scrum Alliance

SAFe® Agilist – Scaled Agile, Inc.